



End of Marvel

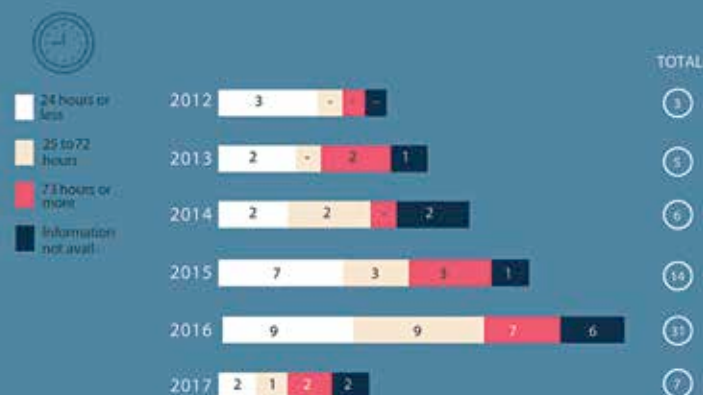
Axel Alonso hinted about Deadpool going on a killing spree again.
<http://dgit.in/KillMarvel>



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Coursera, launches 'Mindshift' to help professionals to learn and discover.
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DURATIONS OF SHUTDOWN



SOURCE: SFLC.IN

As the number of blockages increase, so do our losses from them

Internet blockages has led to apparent over-regulation. Take the example of Kashmir – almost no Indian citizen who has a basic awareness of what's going on in the country needs to be told that the state of Jammu and Kashmir has been in civil unrest. Between 2012 and 2016, Kashmir had 29 internet shutdowns for reasons such as the death anniversary of a rebel leader and a wrestling match at a disputed venue.

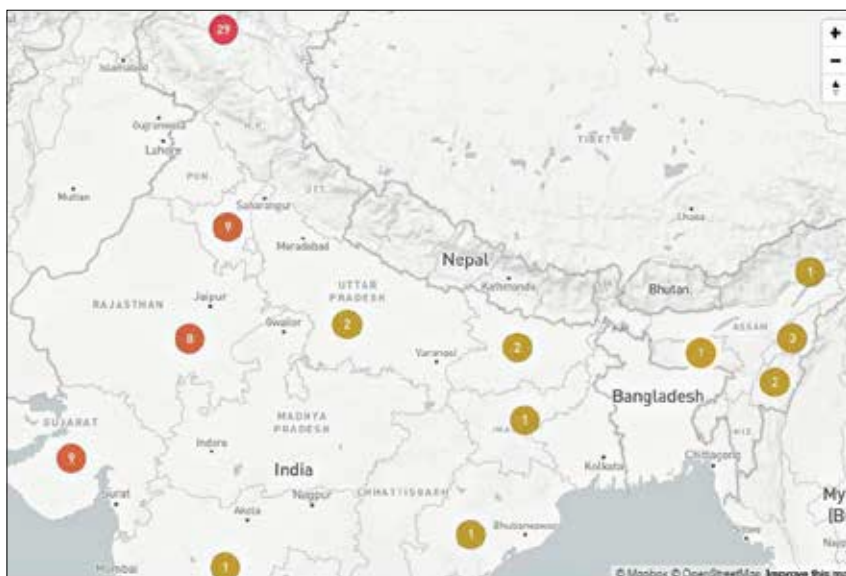
THE LEGALITY

To start off, let us make it clear that internet blockages are perfectly legal in India. There is a provision in our constitution for the same. However, it is how it is done that makes it a bit confusing.

“The Indian IT act doesn't specifically provide for internet blockages. The orders for internet shutdowns are issued under Section 144 of the CrPC” says Asheeta Regidi, cyber law expert, “This gives the judge the authority to take any measures needed for maintaining peace, such as in situations of unrest or riots. The judge has the power to take any measures required, at his discretion, for maintaining the peace. The problem with this is that as the internet is becoming more and more fundamental to daily lives, procedural safeguards are necessary. For example, section 69A of the IT Act, which provides for blocking of websites, has detailed procedures. Either it should be clarified that orders for internet blockages must be passed under Section 69A. Alternatively,

a separate system with similar procedural safeguards should be introduced. Otherwise this leaves scope for misuse and abuse. As seen with the blockage for the clerk exam.”

Essentially, there are a couple of sections of the legal framework that affect internet access in India. Along with Section 144, another legal basis for disruption of internet services may be Section 5 (2) of the Telegraph Act 1885. That legislation was drafted before commercial radio was introduced, which has been modified over the years to grant the government greater power and control over the transmission of messages.



Interactive map at <http://dgit.in/NetShtdwn> that tracks internet shutdowns over the years in India

WHY SHOULD YOU CARE

If you have opened the map mentioned earlier in the story, you might have noticed that the higher numbers of internet shutdowns are limited to a few states – states that have shown greater volatility towards political or communal unrest. You may or may not hail from these states or have anything to do with them. In case you're the latter, you might wonder what all of this has got to do with you. There is one statistic that will change your opinion about this.

The same Brookings Institution study, that we mentioned earlier, goes on to highlight the economic cost of internet blockages. India, over the one year period, lost \$968,080,702 due to blockages for 70 days. That's about ₹10,000 lost on every second of blocked internet. If you had any doubts about the blockages having any adverse effect on our economy, that number should be enough to quell them.

According to the Internet Shutdown report from Centre for Internet and Society, India has a greater tendency to block mobile internet services entirely in situations that warrant control over communications. So, even during that clerical examination, if you wanted to transfer money on the go for any emergency, you couldn't do so without access